We will create a controller to handle the API logic. Run the following command to generate a controller:

```
php artisan make:controller API/SubmissionController
```

Edit `app/Http/Controllers/API/SubmissionController.php`:

```
namespace App\Http\Controllers\API;

use App\Http\Controllers\Controller;
use Illuminate\Http\Request;
use App\Models\Submission;
use Illuminate\Support\Facades\Storage;

class SubmissionController extends Controller
{
    public function store(Request $request)
    {
        $validated = $request->validate([
            'name' => 'required|string',
            'email' => 'required|email',
            'phone' => 'required|string',
            'file' => 'required|file|max:5120', // max 5MB
        ]);

        // Store the file
        $filePath = $request->file('file')->store('uploads', 'public');

        // Save the submission
        $submission = Submission::create([
            'name' => $validated['name'],
            'email' => $validated['email'],
            'phone' => $validated['phone'],
            'file_path' => $filePath,
        ]);

        return response()->json([
            'message' => 'File uploaded successfully.',
            'data' => $submission
        ], 201);
    }
}
```

This controller handles the file upload and saves the metadata in the database. It validates the input, stores the file in the `storage/app/public/uploads` directory, and returns a JSON response with the submission data.

14.13.4.6 Step 6: Register Routes in `api.php`

Open `routes/api.php` and add the route:

```
use App\Http\Controllers\API\SubmissionController;

Route::post('/submit', [SubmissionController::class, 'store']);
```